



CHIDAMBARAM AT THE ALL INDIA CONFERENCE ON THE NATIONAL POPULATION REGISTER; (LEFT) MAPS BEING PRINTED FOR CENSUS 2011

and the official language of the concerned state or the Union territory. These forms will then be scanned at the offices of the Registrar General of India. A printout of certain data fields and photographs will be displayed in specific areas for objections from the public for corrections and checking all identity details. In case somebody has an objection, it will be disposed of through a series of appellate authorities at village, tehsil and district levels. The draft database will be placed before the Gram Sabha or the local bodies for authentication of all the residents.

Once finalised, the NPR database will be sent to the UIDAI for biometric de-duplication and assigning of a unique identification number. The UIDAI will tally it with other sources like telephone bills, electricity bills, and income tax returns to rule out the possible duplicities. Then the UIDAI will allot a unique number to every individual. This UID number will be added to the NPR database. After this process is completed, the unique identity cards are to be issued. There is also a proposal to set up a network of NPR offices at every tehsil so that the NPR data can be updated from time to time. This new proposed department may work as a birth and death registrar as well. But it will get a final shape only after the NPR is completed.

In fact, the first phase of the NPR, which includes coastal population of Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, Kerala, Orissa, Puducherry, Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Goa, Daman and Diu, Lakshadweep and Andaman and Nicobar Islands, is already in process. Biographical details of around 50 lakh people and biometric details of around 10 lakh people have been collected so far. According to the Government, the existence of such a database will enhance the efficacy of providing services to the residents under various government schemes and programmes. It will also improve security scenario in the country and help in

THE BIGGEST EVER

- Over 25 lakh people will be involved in this exercise. Among them, over 21 lakh would be enumerators who will go door to door for headcounting and gathering other related information.
- Census 2011 will cost Rs 7,000 crore, of which Rs 3,540 crore will be spent on the NPR and Rs 1,260 crore on the RGI's infrastructure. The amount spent on every citizen will be Rs 59.
- India Post is being used for the first time to disburse documents printed at 15 different locations to 17,500 officers who in turn will distribute them to the enumerators at the grassroots level.
- Ninety trainers will train 725 master trainers' facilitators who in turn will train over 54,000 master trainers. These master trainers will train enumerators at grassroots level.

C. Chandramouli, registrar general and census commissioner, "Our job will be complicated. We are going to knock every door and count every head within a given time limit." In a country that has 35 provinces, 640 districts, 5,767 tehsils, 7,742 towns, 6,08,786 villages and over 24 crore households, the job is not going to be easy.

The census enumerators dealing with house listing in Census 2011 will also canvass for the NPR schedule. The NPR form has 15 columns and citizens

have to furnish details like their name, relationship to head, father's name, mother's name, spouse's name, sex, date of birth, marital status, place of birth, nationality, present address, duration of stay at the present address, permanent address, occupation and educational qualification. Along with these details, every respondent will be photographed, fingerprints of all the 10 fingers will be taken, and the iris will be scanned. The filled-in NPR schedule will be digitised in two languages—English